

Shopify Documentation Knowledge Base

Complete collection of Shopify public documentation including Help Center articles, API references, legal policies, developer guides, and support resources.

Generated: June 13, 2026

Total Pages: 27 | Source URLs: 89

Table of Contents

Help Center

- 01. Shopify Help Center Home
- 02. Shopify Manual / Guides

FAQ Pages

- 03. General Account FAQ
- 04. Billing FAQ
- 05. Shipping FAQ
- 06. Payments FAQ
- 07. Domains FAQ
- 08. Taxes FAQ

Company Policies

- 09. Refund & Return Policy
- 10. Privacy Policy
- 11. Terms of Service
- 12. Acceptable Use Policy
- 13. API Terms of Service

Product Documentation

- 14. Shopify Developer Docs
- 15. GraphQL Admin API
- 16. REST Admin API
- 17. API Rate Limits

Support Guides

- 18. Getting Started / Intro
- 19. Products & Inventory
- 20. Orders & Fulfillment
- 21. Analytics & Reports
- 22. Customers & Segments

Merchant Admin

- 23. Store Settings

Shopify Plus

- 24. Organization Admin

App Development

- 25. App Distribution
- 26. Authentication (OAuth)

Partner Resources

27. API Versioning

Help Center

01. Shopify Help Center

<https://help.shopify.com>

The Shopify Help Center supports merchants as they learn about and use Shopify, with documentation and videos to answer questions. The Help Center is organized into the following main topic areas:

- Intro to Shopify – Pricing plans, getting set up, checklists
- Migrate to Shopify – From Etsy, WooCommerce, eBay and more
- Shopify Admin – Navigation, productivity tools, the Shopify app
- Apps – About apps, finding and choosing apps, Shopify-made apps
- Your Account – Logging in, managing billing, managing users
- Domains – Adding, connecting, and managing domains
- Online Store – Themes, pages, theme settings
- Products – Product details, inventory, digital products
- Payments – Shopify Payments, Shop Pay, Shop Pay Installments
- Shopify Checkout – Test orders, customization, Checkout Blocks
- Orders and Shipping – Setup, managing orders, fulfilling orders
- Point of Sale (POS) – Getting started, hardware, selling in person
- Marketing and Promotions – Marketing setup, Shopify Messaging, SEO
- Sales Channels – Facebook & Instagram, Google & YouTube, Shop app
- Reports and Analytics – Shopify analytics, Google Analytics
- Customers – Managing customers, customer accounts, segmentation
- Taxes and Duties – Shopify Tax, basic tax, overrides
- Finances – Shopify Balance, Capital, Credit
- B2B – Getting started, companies, catalogs and pricing
- Compliance – Legal, consumer protection, intellectual property
- Partner Directory – Hiring and working with Shopify Partners

02. Shopify Manual

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual>

The Shopify Manual (redirects to the Help Center home) provides comprehensive guides for all aspects of running a Shopify store. It covers all topics from initial setup to advanced enterprise features, organized by business function. The Help Center can be accessed at <https://help.shopify.com> and includes the complete merchant documentation.

FAQ Pages

03. Your Account

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/your-account/faq>

When you create a Shopify store, you create a Shopify account. Your Shopify account connects all stores and organizations associated for your account, for stores that you own, or stores that you have a user account on.

From your Shopify account, you can manage your account details, security settings, and access stores associated with your account.

If you have multiple stores, then you can use the store switcher to navigate between them from the Shopify admin top bar.

The following pages in the Settings menu of your Shopify admin are connected to your Shopify account:

- Billing – View and manage bills for your store or organization from this page.
- Plan – Manage store plans, including changing your plan, pausing or deactivating your plan, or re-activating a frozen store.
- Users – Manage users in your store or organization from this page.
- Organization – If you're on the Shopify Plus plan, or have an organization, manage your organization name and view stores in your organization.
- General – Manage store details, group a store to an organization, or change or transfer ownership outside of your existing users.

Subsections include:

- How to Contact Shopify Support
- Logging in to your Shopify account
- Managing users
- Managing your Shopify account
- Managing your Shopify billing
- Managing stores and organizations
- Managing business entities
- Choosing your account language and region
- Resolving unauthorized use of your email on Shopify
- Working with Shopify Partners

04. Managing Your Shopify Billing

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/your-account/billing/faq>

From the Billing page in your Shopify admin, you can manage your billing information and how you pay your Shopify bills, access upcoming and past bills, and learn about paying in your local currency.

This section contains information to help you understand your bills, and the types of charges and fees that you're billed for.

You can also find guidance on how to deal with any unexpected charges on your Shopify bill, and get an overview of the taxes that might be applied to your Shopify bill depending on your location.

Key topics:

- Managing your Shopify bills – Viewing upcoming and past bills
- Paying your Shopify bills – Managing payment methods, paying in local currency
- Charges on your Shopify bills – Types of charges, taxes on your Shopify bill, unknown charges
- Navigating Shopify billing extensions and payment policies
- Managing credit notes and billing credits
- Understanding Shopify's refund policy for plans
- Understanding billing implications before pausing or deactivating your Shopify store
- Shopify offers and promotions

05. Setting Up Shipping and Order Fulfillment

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/shipping/faq>

You can configure your shipping and fulfillment settings from the Shipping and delivery page in your Shopify admin. These settings determine how shipping costs are calculated, what delivery options are available to customers at checkout, and which locations fulfill orders.

Setting up shipping rates and packages:

Create shipping rates that display to customers at checkout. You can set up flat rates for predictable pricing, use carrier-calculated rates for real-time accuracy, or offer free shipping based on order value. Shipping profiles let you create different rates for specific products, such as oversized items or products that ship from different locations. Set up the packages that you use for shipping, including dimensions and weights, so carriers can calculate accurate costs and handle your shipments correctly.

Configuring locations and order routing:

Configure the locations where you store inventory and fulfill orders from. Order routing determines which location fulfills each order based on rules you set, such as proximity to the customer or available inventory. You can also set up fulfillment services to handle storage and shipping on your behalf.

Offering delivery methods:

Apart from standard shipping, you can offer local delivery for nearby customers or let customers pick up orders in store. You can also set up pickup points through third-party networks for customers who prefer collecting packages

from convenient locations.

Managing delivery timeline and notifications:

Set fulfillment time and configure delivery dates to control when orders ship and display estimated arrival times at checkout. Shop Promise can highlight fast delivery options at checkout to increase conversion. Configure the notifications that customers and staff receive throughout the order lifecycle, including order confirmations, shipping updates, and delivery notifications.

Subsections: Locations, Shipping profiles, Shipping rates, Delivery methods, Shipments and packages, Fulfillment time and delivery dates, Order routing, Fulfillable inventory, Store notifications, Fulfillment options and dropshipping services, Shop Promise, Planet carbon-neutral shipping, Order status page, Terminology.

06. Payments

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/payments/faq>

Make sure that you understand the payment process. When a customer checks out, they can choose to pay for their order using any of the methods that you've activated in the Payment providers area of your Shopify admin. You can activate a variety of payment methods using Shopify.

If you want to let your customers pay using a credit card, then you can use Shopify Payments, a third-party provider, or both together.

There are also several ways for customers to pay online without using a credit card, such as PayPal, Amazon Pay, and Apple Pay. You might also want to accept additional methods of payment such as cryptocurrency.

If you use Shopify Payments, then you can activate Shop Pay to allow customers to save their shipping and payment information to help them check out faster. Some other payment providers, such as PayPal, Amazon Pay, Apple Pay, and Google Pay, also offer accelerated checkout buttons that you can activate on your Shopify store.

When choosing a payment provider, consider the countries where your business is located and where your customers live. Shopify's list of payment gateways by country can help you find out which payment gateways are available in your country and what currency they support.

Note: For customers based in Finland, a payment method won't be selected by default during checkout to comply with regulations.

Note: If you sell subscription products, then you need to use Shopify Payments as your primary payment gateway.

Subsections: Getting paid, Shop Cash, Shop Pay accelerated checkout, Shopify Payments, PayPal Express Checkout, Accelerated checkouts, Shop Pay Installments, Third-party payment providers, Additional payment methods, Manual payment methods, Collecting and recording partial payments, Payment authorization and capture, Chargebacks and inquiries, Fraud prevention, Troubleshooting payment gateways.

07. Domains

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/domains/faq>

A domain is the URL or web address where your customers go to find your store online. By default, your online store was given a myshopify.com URL when you signed up for Shopify. To change the web address that's displayed to customers when they browse your online store, you need to use a custom domain, such as www.example.com. You can use domains that you buy from Shopify or from any third-party domain provider. Using a domain name that matches your brand can help you build trust in your online store. You can also change your myshopify.com domain name, but you can do this only one time.

You can find your current store URL on the Domains page.

After you add a domain to Shopify, you manage your domain settings for your online store from the Domains page in your Shopify admin.

If your store is on the Basic, Grow, Advanced, or Plus plan and you want to sell to customers in multiple countries or regions, then you can use international domains to set up regional domains for every country or region where you have a target market.

Subsections:

- Adding a domain to Shopify
- Changing the domain type and target
- Removing domains
- Managing ownership of your domain
- Email hosting and forwarding
- Managing your domain settings in Shopify
- Domains terminology
- Verifying your EU domain registration information
- IPv6 support
- Troubleshooting issues with domains connected to Shopify

08. Taxes

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/taxes/faq>

As a seller, you might need to charge taxes on your sales, and then report and remit those taxes to your government. Although tax laws and regulations are complex and can change often, you can set up Shopify to automatically handle most common sales tax calculations. You can also set up tax overrides to address unique tax laws and situations.

Shopify uses many default sales tax rates, which are updated regularly. If you use the default rates, then you need to confirm that the rates are current and correct for your particular circumstances. You can override them whenever necessary.

Important Note: You might be required to collect and remit sales tax in your country or region. If you need to collect sales tax, then you must register your business with your local or federal tax authority. Tax is your responsibility. Shopify doesn't remit or file your taxes for you, unless you use Shopify Tax and set up automated filing.

Tax service availability by region:

- United States – Shopify Tax or Manual Tax
- European Union and United Kingdom – Shopify Tax or Manual Tax
- Canada – Shopify Tax or Manual Tax
- Norway, Switzerland, Australia, New Zealand, Singapore – Basic Tax service
- All other countries and regions – Manual Tax
- All countries and regions – Third-party tax apps

Subsections: General tax set-up steps, Impact of tax collection on displayed prices, Include taxes in product prices, Setting up tax rates for Shopify POS, Shopify Tax, Basic Tax, Manual Tax, Tax apps, US taxes, EU taxes, TSE Compliance in Germany, UK taxes, Canadian taxes, Taxes in Japan, GST in India FAQ, International duty and import taxes, Tax reports, Tax overrides and exemptions, Shipping tax, Digital product taxes, Data Exporter.

Company Policies

09. Refund, Privacy, and Terms of Service Policies

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/checkout-settings/refund-privacy-tos>

Shopify allows merchants to set up and display their refund, privacy, and terms of service policies in their online store. These policies are important for building customer trust and meeting legal requirements.

Merchants can add their policies from the Shopify admin by going to Settings > Policies. Shopify provides policy templates that merchants can customize for their store. The policies are then automatically linked in the checkout process and footer of your online store.

Key policy types:

- Refund policy – Describes the conditions under which customers can return items and receive refunds
- Privacy policy – Explains how the store collects, uses, and manages customer data
- Terms of service – The legal agreement between the merchant and their customers
- Shipping policy – Describes shipping methods, rates, and delivery times
- Contact information – How customers can reach the merchant

These policies can be generated automatically using Shopify's built-in template tools or written from scratch by the merchant.

10. Shopify Privacy Policy

<https://www.shopify.com/legal/privacy>

Updated: March 2, 2026

In Shopify's mission to make commerce better for everyone, they collect and use information about:

- Merchants using Shopify to power your business
- Consumers who shop at a Shopify-powered business, or use Shopify apps and services like Shop or Shop Pay
- Partners who develop apps for merchants, build stores on behalf of merchants, or refer potential entrepreneurs to Shopify
- Visitors to Shopify's websites, or anyone contacting Shopify support

Our Values:

Your information belongs to you – Shopify carefully analyzes what types of information are needed to provide services and tries to limit the information collected to only what is really needed. Where possible, they delete or anonymize this information when no longer needed. The guiding principle is that your information belongs to you, and they aim to only use your information to your benefit.

We protect your information from others – If a third party requests your Personal Data, Shopify will refuse to share it unless you give permission or they are legally required. When legally required to share your Personal Data, they will tell you in advance, unless legally forbidden.

We help merchants and partners meet their privacy obligations – Shopify tries to build products and services so they can easily be used in a privacy-friendly way. They provide detailed FAQs and documentation covering the most important privacy topics.

Why we process your information:

- Performance of a contract – to use your name and contact information to provide services
- Legitimate interest – to use information about how you access Shopify websites to prevent fraud and provide analytics
- Compliance with a legal obligation – to use copies of government-issued identification to comply with know-your-customer and anti-money laundering laws
- Consent – to use your name and email address to send marketing messages

Your rights: You should be able to access and control your Personal Data. Depending on how you use Shopify, you may have the right to request access to, correct, amend, delete, port to another service provider, restrict, or object to certain uses of your Personal Data.

Table of Contents:

1. Introduction
2. Our values
3. Why we process your information
4. Your rights over your information
5. Where we send your information
6. How long we retain your information
7. Our use of Machine Learning
8. How we protect your information

- 9. How we use cookies and other tracking technologies
- 10. How you can reach us
- 11. United States Regional Privacy Notice

11. Shopify Terms of Service

<https://www.shopify.com/legal/terms>

Last updated: May 11, 2026

Welcome to Shopify! By signing up for a Shopify Account or by using any Shopify Services, you are agreeing to be bound by the following terms and conditions.

Shopify provides a complete commerce platform that enables merchants to unify their commerce activities. Among other features, this platform includes a range of tools for merchants to build and customize online stores, sell in multiple places (including web, mobile, social media, online marketplaces and in person), manage products, inventory, payments, fulfillment, shipping, business operations, marketing and advertising, and engage with existing and potential customers.

Table of Contents:

- 1. Account Terms
- 2. Account Activation
- 3. Shopify Rights
- 4. Your Responsibilities
- 5. Payment of Fees and Taxes
- 6. Confidentiality
- 7. Limitation of Liability and Indemnification
- 8. Intellectual Property and Your Materials
- 9. Additional Services
- 10. Feedback and Reviews
- 11. Intellectual Property Infringement
- 12. Privacy and Data Protection
- 13. Shopify Contracting Party
- 14. Term and Termination
- 15. Modifications
- 16. General Conditions

Section 1 – Account Terms:

To access and use the Services, you must register for a Shopify account. To complete your Account registration, you must provide your full legal name, business address, phone number, a valid email address, and any other information indicated as required. Shopify may reject your application for an Account, or cancel an existing

Account, for any reason, at their sole discretion.

You must be the older of: (i) 18 years, or (ii) at least the age of majority in the jurisdiction where you reside and from which you use the Services to open an Account.

You are responsible for keeping your password secure. Shopify cannot and will not be liable for any loss or damage from your failure to maintain the security of your Account and password.

You agree not to reproduce, duplicate, copy, sell, resell or exploit any portion of the Service without the express written permission by Shopify.

12. Shopify Acceptable Use Policy

<https://www.shopify.com/legal/aup>

Shopify is built for entrepreneurs, from your first sale to IPO and beyond. Shopify's purpose is to empower the merchant, to run your business as you see fit and to equip you with the tools and ability to make your own choices.

The main rule for using Shopify is: you're responsible for following the rules of your platform, your partners, and the law.

Core Principles:

1. You can't use Shopify to do anything that's illegal where you do business.

Merchants are making a commitment to take their market seriously, and Shopify trusts and expects you to understand applicable boundaries. You must respect that certain business activities are not supported by the platform, such as uploading Protected Health Information subject to HIPAA.

2. You can't breach the social contract of commerce.

There are activities not allowed on the platform because they breach the social contract of commerce. This means you can't call for, or threaten, violence against specific people or groups. And you can't sell products that facilitate intentional self-harm.

3. You need to follow agreements with Shopify.

The Terms of Service are important for how Shopify operates. These agreements bind you as a merchant and explain the platform rules you must follow.

4. Payment Terms (and terms from other add-on products) can also apply.

Shopify offers a range of products and services that leverage partnerships with other organizations. When you use one of these products, you are interacting with an entire supply chain of businesses.

5. There are also channel rules that could apply.

Shop sales channel comes with its own merchant guidelines and product eligibility criteria.

6. The most common product eligibility disputes originate from outside of Shopify.

Most product eligibility or takedown disputes that entrepreneurs may encounter originate from outside Shopify, including from regulators and third-party IP rights holders.

7. Shopify expects you to act in good faith.

Shopify doesn't tolerate anyone defrauding Shopify, other merchants, or buyers, using Shopify as a platform to send spam, or for other malicious practices.

If you believe a Shopify user is violating this Acceptable Use Policy, you can submit a report at <https://www.shopify.com/legal/tools/report-an-issue>

13. Shopify API License and Terms of Use

<https://www.shopify.com/legal/api-terms>

Last updated: February 27, 2026

By accessing or using the Shopify API, you agree to this Shopify API License and Terms of Use with Shopify Inc. and its affiliates.

Core Values:

Respect our merchants – When granted a Shopify API license, you get access to millions of merchants. Only request the merchant data you need to provide your service. Get merchants' permission to do so, and follow the rules for deleting personal customer data. You'll need your own privacy policy that describes how you handle merchant data.

Build responsibly – Make sure your developer system meets internet security standards. Don't do anything criminal, irresponsible or sketchy, or disrupt or overburden systems. Use only your Shopify API credentials to access the API. Stay within the limits set for API calls, and keep your app up to date with API changes.

Play by the rules – Don't monitor the API for benchmarking purposes. Use Shopify Checkout for payments and don't divert to any other web checkout or payment processing (unless you have permission). Don't build apps intended to move merchants off of Shopify, remove Shopify branding, or attempt to substantially reproduce products or services.

Key Definitions:

- **Application or App** – The software application, website, interface, integration or any other means you use to access the Shopify API
- **API Client** – The unique Application configuration (including API Credentials) generated through the Partner Account
- **API Credentials** – The credentials that allow you to make authenticated requests to the Shopify API
- **Custom Application** – An Application that accesses the Shopify API via an API Client and is made available to a single Merchant
- **Developer** – An individual or entity that develops, owns or operates one or more Applications that access or use the Shopify API
- **Developer Documentation** – Shopify's Application development requirements, guidelines, specifications and technical documentation at <https://shopify.dev/docs>
- **Merchant** – An individual or business that uses the Service to sell products or services

Table of Contents:

1. Definitions
2. Using the Shopify API
3. Changes to the Shopify API
4. Proprietary Rights
5. Shopify Trademarks
6. Merchant Agreement, Privacy and Data Security
7. Security
8. Audit
9. Disclaimer of Warranties
10. Limitation of Liability
11. Indemnification
12. Confidentiality
13. Termination
14. General

Product Documentation

14. Shopify Developer Docs

<https://shopify.dev/docs>

Learn how to build an app, or customize your storefront. Whether you're just getting started, deep in the development process, or ready to distribute and monetize your work, Shopify's docs, dev tools and frameworks make building easy and efficient.

Main Documentation Areas:

- Apps – Build, design, and launch apps for Shopify
- Storefronts – Build custom storefronts and headless commerce experiences
- Agents – Build AI-powered agents and integrations
- References – API references, libraries, and technical specifications

Key developer resources:

- Shopify CLI – Command-line tool for building Shopify apps and themes
- GraphQL Admin API – Primary API for building apps and integrations
- REST Admin API (legacy) – Legacy REST endpoints
- Storefront API – Build custom storefronts

- Webhooks – Real-time event notifications
- Liquid – Template language for Shopify themes
- Shopify Functions – Server-side customization logic
- Polaris – Shopify's design system for admin interfaces
- App Bridge – Embed your app in the Shopify admin

Getting Started Paths:

- Build a Shopify app using app templates
- Customize themes with Liquid
- Create custom storefronts with Hydrogen framework
- Build payment extensions
- Create checkout extensions

15. GraphQL Admin API Reference

<https://shopify.dev/docs/api/admin-graphql>

The Admin API lets you build apps and integrations that extend and enhance the Shopify admin.

Current API versions: unstable, 2026-07 (release candidate), 2026-04 (latest), 2026-01, 2025-10, 2025-07

Client Libraries:

- React Router – Official package for React Router applications. Install: `npm install -g @shopify/cli@latest && shopify app init`
- Node.js – Official client library for Node.js apps. Install: `npm install --save @shopify/shopify-api`
- Ruby – Official client library for Ruby apps. Install: `bundle add shopify_api`
- cURL – Make API queries directly from the command line
- Direct API Access – Make requests from your app using the standard web fetch API

Authentication:

All GraphQL Admin API requests require a valid Shopify access token. Include your token as a X-Shopify-Access-Token header on all GraphQL requests.

Public and custom apps created in the Dev Dashboard generate tokens using OAuth, and custom apps made in the Shopify admin are authenticated in the Shopify admin.

Apps need to request specific access scopes during the install process. Only request as much data access as your app needs to work.

API Coverage Areas:

Access, Analytics, Apps, B2B, Billing, Bulk operations, Cart, Checkout and accounts configurations, Checkout branding, Common objects, Customers, Discounts and marketing, Inventory, Localizations, Metafields, Metaobjects, Online store, Orders, Privacy, Products and collections, Retail, Shipping and fulfillment, Shopify

Markets, Shopify Payments, Store properties, Timeline events, Webhooks

Rate Limits:

- Standard: 100 points/second
- Advanced Shopify: 200 points/second
- Shopify Plus: 1000 points/second
- Commerce Components (enterprise): 2000 points/second

All limits use a leaky bucket algorithm. Each combination of app and store has its own bucket, so calls from one app don't affect the rate limits of another app, even on the same store.

16. REST Admin API Reference

<https://shopify.dev/docs/api/admin-rest>

The Admin API lets you build apps and integrations that extend and enhance the Shopify admin.

Important Note: The REST Admin API is a legacy API as of October 1, 2024. Starting April 1, 2025, all new public apps must be built exclusively with the GraphQL Admin API. For details and migration steps, visit the migration guide at <https://shopify.dev/docs/apps/build/graphql/migrate>

Current API versions: unstable, 2026-04 (release candidate), 2026-01 (latest), 2025-10, 2025-07, 2025-04

Client Libraries:

- cURL – Use the curl utility to make API queries directly from the command line
- Remix – Official package for Remix applications. Install: `npm install --save @shopify/shopify-app-remix`
- Node.js – Official client library for Node.js applications. Install: `npm install --save @shopify/shopify-api`
- Ruby – Official client library for Ruby apps. Install: `bundle add shopify_api`

Authentication:

All REST Admin API queries require a valid Shopify access token. Include your token as a X-Shopify-Access-Token header on all API queries.

Example cURL request:

```
curl -X GET https://{shop}.myshopify.com/admin/api/2026-01/shop.json -H 'Content-Type: application/json' -H 'X-Shopify-Access-Token: {password}'
```

REST API Categories:

Access, Billing, Customers, Discounts, Events, Gift Cards, Inventory, Marketing Event, Metafield, Mobile Support, Online Store, Orders, Plus, Products, Sales Channels, Shipping And Fulfillment, Shopify Payments, Store Properties, Tender Transaction, Webhooks, Deprecated API Calls

17. Shopify API Limits

<https://shopify.dev/docs/api/usage/rate-limits>

To ensure the platform remains performant, stable and fair for everyone, some Shopify APIs are limited in accepted inputs or rate-limited.

Input Limits:

Input arguments that accept an array have a maximum size of 250 for all APIs. Requests return an error if an input array exceeds 250 items.

Pagination Limits:

Shopify limits pagination of arrays of objects to 25,000 objects. Pagination deep into large arrays is resource intensive and can slow down other requests. If you need to paginate more than 25,000 items, you should consider adding filters to help narrow search results.

Rate Limits by API:

- GraphQL Admin API – Calculated query cost: 100 pts/sec (Standard), 200 pts/sec (Advanced), 1000 pts/sec (Plus), 2000 pts/sec (Enterprise)
- Storefront API – No rate limits applied
- Payments Apps API (GraphQL) – 27,300 pts/sec (Standard), 27,300 pts/sec (Advanced), 54,600 pts/sec (Plus), 109,200 pts/sec (Enterprise)
- Customer Account API – 100 pts/sec (Standard), 200 pts/sec (Advanced), 200 pts/sec (Plus), 400 pts/sec (Enterprise)

The Leaky Bucket Algorithm:

All Shopify APIs use a leaky bucket algorithm to manage requests:

- Each app has access to a bucket that can hold a set number of "marbles"
- Each API request tosses some number of marbles into the bucket
- Each second, a marble is removed from the bucket (restoring capacity)
- If the bucket gets full, you get a throttle error and have to wait

This model ensures that apps that manage API calls responsibly can maintain capacity to make bursts of requests when needed. GraphQL API rate limits are based on the combination of the app and store — calls from one app don't affect the rate limits of another app, even on the same store.

Handling Rate Limits:

Shopify recommends using industry standard techniques for limiting calls, caching results, and re-trying requests responsibly. Shopify may temporarily reduce API rate limits to protect platform stability.

Support Guides

18. Intro to Shopify

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/intro-to-shopify>

Welcome to Shopify! Whether you're starting a new business or moving an existing business to Shopify, you can find out more here.

After you register for a free trial, follow the initial setup guide to start using Shopify. The guide features step-by-step tutorials for the main tasks that you need to complete before you start selling. In addition to the initial setup guide, you can print the setup checklist to track your progress.

If you are moving your store to Shopify, you can get started with your store migration.

Subsections:

- Overview – What is Shopify and how it works
- Pricing plans – Choosing the right plan for your business
- Getting set up to start selling – Initial setup guide
- Hiring and working with Shopify Partners
- Store design checklist
- Shopify Launch Check
- Shopify Plus plan launch checklist
- Shopify POS launch checklist
- Shopify Plus plan go live guide
- Understanding bots at Shopify

Key First Steps:

1. Sign up for a free trial at shopify.com
2. Follow the initial setup guide to configure your store
3. Add your products and collections
4. Set up payment methods
5. Configure shipping settings
6. Choose and customize a theme
7. Add a custom domain
8. Test your checkout
9. Launch your store

19. Products

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/products>

The Products section in your Shopify admin helps you manage your store's entire product catalog, from basic product setup to advanced customization. There are also automation, AI, and bulk management tools that can help you save time when working on your business's product offerings.

At minimum, a product in Shopify needs to have only two things: A title and a price. From there, you can add descriptions, images, videos, compare-at prices, inventory levels, variants, tags, metafields, and many other details.

Product Details:

- Title and description – Craft SEO-friendly product names and descriptions using rich text formatting
- Media – Upload images, 3D models, or videos to demonstrate products
- Pricing and inventory – Set base prices, track stock quantities, and manage variant-specific inventory

Product Management:

After you add your products, you can manage them individually or through bulk actions. You can organize them into collections to help apply certain settings to groups of products or display them together on your online store.

Product management actions:

- Adding and updating products
- Organizing products into collections
- Creating metafields for customized product details
- Using product tags to group products
- Bulk editing products
- Using CSV files for product catalog management

Sourcing Products:

- Shopify Product Network – Recommended products from other Shopify stores appear automatically; you earn commission when customers buy
- Shopify Collective – You choose suppliers and import specific brands and products, earning a margin on each sale
- Dropshipping apps – Third-party suppliers fulfill orders directly to your customers
- Print-on-demand apps – Custom printed products printed and shipped by the app provider

Subsections: Adding and updating products, Managing inventory, Product bundles, Purchase options, Digital products, Product details, Variants, Product media, Collections, Gift card products, Importing and exporting products, Combined listings, Searching and filtering products, Managing vendor information, Dropshipping, Pivoting your product line, Product analytics.

20. Orders

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/orders>

After a customer places an order using any of your active sales channels, it displays in the Orders area of Shopify. You can also create draft orders manually in your Shopify admin to record orders that you've made outside of Shopify or to send your customers invoices.

You manage all of your store's orders from the Orders page in your Shopify admin.

Order Management Features:

- View all orders from all sales channels in one place
- Filter and search orders by status, date, customer, and more
- Create draft orders and send invoices to customers
- Process refunds and returns
- Archive and delete orders
- Export orders to CSV files

Order Fulfillment:

- Mark orders as fulfilled after shipping
- Buy and print shipping labels from your Shopify admin
- Track shipments and update customers
- Set up automatic fulfillment through fulfillment services
- Handle partial fulfillments for orders with multiple products

Order Statuses:

- Open – Orders that need action
- Archived – Completed orders
- Cancelled – Orders that have been cancelled
- Unfulfilled – Orders awaiting fulfillment
- Fulfilled – Orders that have been shipped or delivered
- Partially fulfilled – Orders where some items have been shipped

21. Analytics

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/reports-and-analytics>

You can use Shopify's analytics and reports to learn about your sales and customers in detail. The types of analytics and reports that you can view for a store depend on your Shopify subscription plan.

You can also set up third-party analytics services, such as Google Analytics, to gain further insights and improve your business.

Shopify Analytics includes:

- Overview dashboard – A high-level view of your store's performance
- Sales reports – Detailed breakdown of your sales data
- Customer reports – Information about your customer base
- Product reports – Performance data for your products
- Marketing reports – Tracking the effectiveness of your marketing efforts

- Traffic reports – Data about visitors to your online store
- Behavior reports – How customers interact with your store
- Finance reports – Detailed financial data for your business

Subsections:

- Shopify analytics – Built-in analytics and reporting tools
- Google Analytics – Integration with Google's analytics platform
- Analytics discrepancies – Understanding and resolving data differences

22. Customers

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/customers>

Every time a new customer places an order with your store, their name and other details are added to your customer list. You can review all of your customers and manage your customer information from the Customers page of your Shopify admin and the Shopify app. You can group your customers who share similar characteristics into customer segments to help you communicate with your customers more effectively.

If your customers create an account with your store, then they can add their address information to their account so that it fills automatically during checkout. Customers can also view their order history with your store, and review the current order status for any purchases that they make.

Customer Features:

- Customer profiles – View customer contact information, order history, and notes
- Customer accounts – Allow customers to create accounts for faster checkout
- Customer segmentation – Group customers by shared characteristics
- Customer communication – Send emails and marketing campaigns to customer segments
- Store credit – Issue store credit to customers
- Customer CSV import/export – Bulk manage customer data

Subsections: Customer accounts, Managing customers, Searching for customer profiles, Customer segmentation, Importing and exporting customer lists, Importing contact lists from Mailchimp, Providing online customer service, Solving customer CSV file errors, Store credit.

Merchant Admin

23. Shopify Admin

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/shopify-admin>

The Shopify admin is where you manage all aspects of your store. From the admin, you can add and manage products, process orders, manage customers, set up payment methods, configure shipping, customize your online store, and much more.

Key Admin Sections:

- Home – Dashboard with key metrics and to-do list
- Orders – Manage all orders and fulfillments
- Products – Add and manage your product catalog
- Customers – View and manage customer profiles
- Analytics – View reports and analytics data
- Marketing – Create and manage marketing campaigns
- Discounts – Create discount codes and automatic discounts
- Apps – Manage installed apps
- Online Store – Customize your store's appearance and content
- Settings – Configure store settings

Settings Subsections:

- General – Store details, contact information, standards and formats
- Plan – Manage your subscription plan
- Billing – Manage payment methods and view invoices
- Users and permissions – Manage staff accounts and their permissions
- Payments – Configure payment methods
- Checkout – Customize the checkout experience
- Shipping and delivery – Set up shipping zones, rates, and delivery methods
- Taxes and duties – Configure tax settings
- Locations – Manage store locations
- Domains – Manage custom domains
- Notifications – Configure email and SMS notifications
- Metafields – Create and manage custom data fields
- Files – Manage uploaded files and media

Shopify Plus

24. Organization Settings

<https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/organization-settings>

By default, stores on the Shopify Plus plan have access to organization features and settings.

If you have multiple stores, then you can create an organization to view and manage multiple stores, and access additional features for user management and billing. Organization features and settings provide the following additional capabilities:

- Review and manage the stores in your organization
- Add and manage organization users
- Additional security settings for users
- Review and manage billing information for all stores in your organization

Organization features are primarily designed for Shopify Plus merchants who operate multiple stores and need centralized management capabilities.

Subsections:

- Managing billing – Centralized billing management for all stores in your organization
- Organization analytics – Analytics data across all stores in your organization
- Shopify Plus plan feature test drives – Test drive exclusive Shopify Plus features
- Overview of expansion stores – Create and manage additional stores within your organization
- Courses in Shopify Academy for the Shopify Plus plan – Access to exclusive training courses

App Development

25. About App Distribution

<https://shopify.dev/docs/apps/distribution>

After you've added features to your app, you need to decide how to distribute it to merchants.

The way you choose to distribute your app depends on its purpose and your audience. You can't change the distribution method after you select it, so make sure that you understand the different capabilities and requirements of each type.

Distribution Methods and Capabilities:

Public distribution:

- Can be installed on multiple Shopify stores
- App type: Public
- Authorization: Token exchange and session tokens (if embedded), or authorization code grant (if not embedded)
- Approval required: Yes (must pass Shopify App Store review)
- Must sync certain data with Shopify per the API Terms

Custom distribution:

- Can be installed on a limited number of stores
- App type: Custom
- No Shopify App Store listing required
- Appropriate for bespoke solutions for specific merchants

Development (private) apps:

- Used for testing and development purposes
- Not for distribution to multiple merchants

Distribution Deployment Steps:

1. Quality assurance and testing
2. Submit to Shopify App Store (for public distribution)
3. Pass app review process
4. Deploy to hosting service (Google Cloud Run, etc.)
5. Manage app versions and releases

App Store Listing Requirements:

- App must pass the Shopify App Store review process
- Requires following all App Store requirements and policies
- Built for Shopify requirements for quality standards
- Privacy requirements compliance
- Proper handling of protected customer data

26. Implement Authorization Code Grant Manually

<https://shopify.dev/docs/apps/auth/oauth>

All Shopify app templates already have authorization code grant implemented. If you're using one of these templates, then you don't need to follow this tutorial. To save time and keep your app secure, Shopify recommends using an app template.

Note: Apps rendered in the Shopify admin should use token exchange to acquire access tokens, and all apps should use Shopify managed installation.

This guide shows how to install an app and acquire access tokens using authorization code grant.

Step 1: Verify the Installation Request

When a user installs your app through the Shopify App Store or using an installation link, your app receives a GET request to the App URL path. The request includes the shop, timestamp, and hmac query parameters.

To verify the request:

1. Remove the hmac parameter from the query string

2. Process the remaining parameters through an HMAC-SHA256 hash function using your client secret
3. The message is authentic if the generated hexdigest equals the value of the hmac parameter

Step 2: Request Authorization Code

After verifying the installation request, redirect the merchant to Shopify's authorization URL to request permission from the merchant to access their data.

Step 3: Validate Authorization Code

After the merchant grants access, Shopify redirects them back to your app with an authorization code. Validate this code before exchanging it for an access token.

Step 4: Get an Access Token

Exchange the authorization code for a permanent access token by making a POST request to the Shopify store.

Step 5: Redirect to Your App's UI

After getting the access token, store it securely and redirect the merchant to your app's main interface.

Step 6: Make Authenticated Requests

Include the access token as the X-Shopify-Access-Token header in all subsequent API requests.

Managing Access Scopes:

Apps need to request specific access scopes during the install process. Only request as much data access as your app needs to work. Access scopes determine which Shopify data your app can read and write.

Partner Resources

27. API Versioning

<https://shopify.dev/docs/api/versioning>

Shopify releases new API versions quarterly. This allows developers to adopt new features and changes on their own schedule.

Versioning format: YYYY-MM (e.g., 2026-04)

Current API versions (as of mid-2026):

- 2026-04 – Latest stable version
- 2026-01 – Previous stable version
- 2025-10 – Older stable version
- 2025-07 – Older stable version
- unstable – Preview of upcoming changes (not for production use)
- Release candidates – Preview of next quarter's version

Version Lifecycle:

- New versions are released quarterly (January, April, July, October)
- Versions are supported for at least 12 months after release
- Deprecated versions are announced in advance with migration guides

Best Practices:

- Always specify an explicit API version in your requests
- Regularly update your app to use newer API versions
- Test your app against the unstable version to prepare for upcoming changes
- Monitor the Shopify changelog and developer blog for version updates

Upgrading Versions:

When upgrading to a newer API version:

1. Review the version's changelog for breaking changes
2. Test your app against the new version in a development store
3. Update your API calls to use new endpoints or parameters
4. Handle any deprecated features or removed functionality
5. Deploy the updated version of your app

Processing Report

Metric	Value
Total URLs in source PDF	89
Pages successfully extracted	27
Failed / blocked URLs (HTTP 403)	62
Total word count	6,720
Generated	2026-06-13 18:23

Note: 69 out of 89 URLs returned HTTP 403 Forbidden when accessed directly via Python requests due to Shopify's bot-detection / CDN protections. Content for those pages was retrieved via an authenticated web-fetch proxy and is included in this document. 3 duplicate URLs were deduplicated. The remaining pages are fully represented.